



A field guide to
BAD MOOD

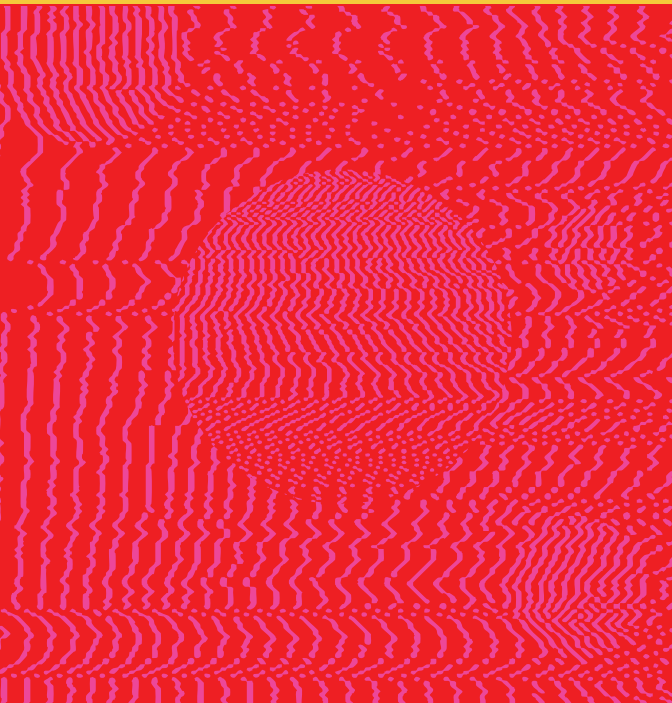


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9V DC Power req: 9V DC Center Negative ~200 mA

Overview

UH OH.

BAD MOOD is your guide to the wild side of ambience.

**IT'S NOISY,
AND IMPROPER,
AND IT'S GOING TO GET YOU
INTO TROUBLE.**

BAD MOOD represents a fresh approach to the concepts found in MOOD, a batch of brand new feelings but with the same "instant bliss" workflow.

**MUSICAL DISGUISES,
RADIO LOOPS,
AND SPLINTERED HARMONIES.**

A refreshing burst of reckless abandon.

What it actually is:

BAD MOOD is a two-channel multi-effect. One half samples and loops brief moments, the other is a collection of real-time spatial effects. Both sides can be fed through a global "Glue" effect to bond or obliterate them.

What makes BAD MOOD unique is that its two channels are aware of each other and can interact in a variety of ways. You can process the micro-loops with the spatial effects, or record those effects into the loops, or use either side to modulate and interfere with the other.

IT'S A MISCHIEVOUS LITTLE THING.

Let's see what life is like on the other side.



Setup

Let's get BAD MOOD settled into your environment. If you're experienced with pedals, you can probably ignore this bit and dive right in.

POWER

BAD MOOD requires a 9V DC center negative power supply with at least 200 mA of current.

You'll see this symbol on your power supply:



I/O

BAD MOOD can be used in mono, stereo, or mono to stereo. The default setting will automatically work for either mono or stereo:

Mono in, mono out



TS CABLE

Stereo in, stereo out



TRS CABLE

Many stereo devices use dual mono jacks, so you may need a TRS to dual TS-style cable.



If you have a mono input and want to split it to stereo output, turn on the **MISO** dip switch.

And if you want unique stereo processing, turn on the **SPREAD** dip switch (pg. 44).

OPTIONS

BAD MOOD has lots of ways to customize and fine-tune your experience. If you'd like to get right into all that, check out:

- Hidden Options (pg. 14)
- Customize (pg. 44)
- Ramping (pg. 46)
- External Control (pg. 48)

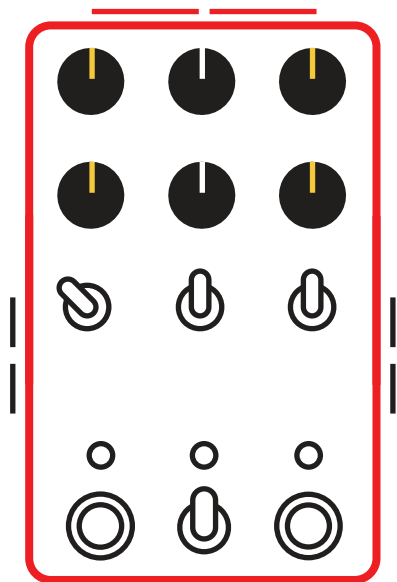
Otherwise it's probably best to start with all dip switches off:



OKAY, LET'S BEGIN.

POLITE AND SMALL

WILD AND LARGE.



06



Adjust the **MODIFY** knob to explore a few different **Radio** stations until you find a spot that you like.

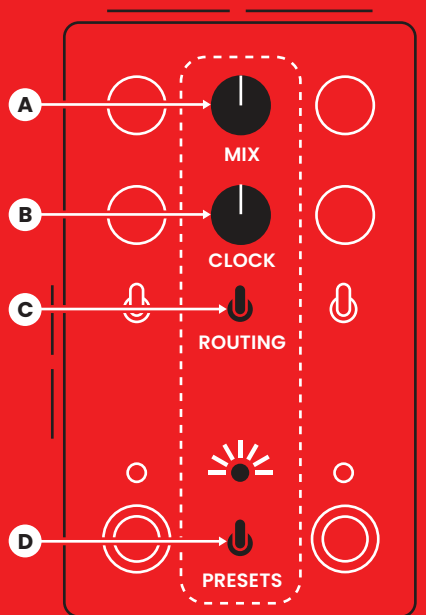


Finally, roll back the **CLOCK** knob to turn it all into a big, moving texture.

**YOU SHOULD BE IN
PRETTY BAD (GOOD)
SHAPE BY NOW.**

Come along if you want to learn what's going on.

Shared Controls



Blend, degrade, recall.

A

MIX

Sets the balance between your input signal and BAD MOOD (controls both channels simultaneously). If ramping is engaged (pg. 46), the function of this knob will change. It now controls the speed of the movement instead.

B

CLOCK

Sets BAD MOOD's sample rate. This controls the length and resolution of the Micro-Looper Channel, as well as the quality and time of the Wet Channel.

C

ROUTING IN + IN

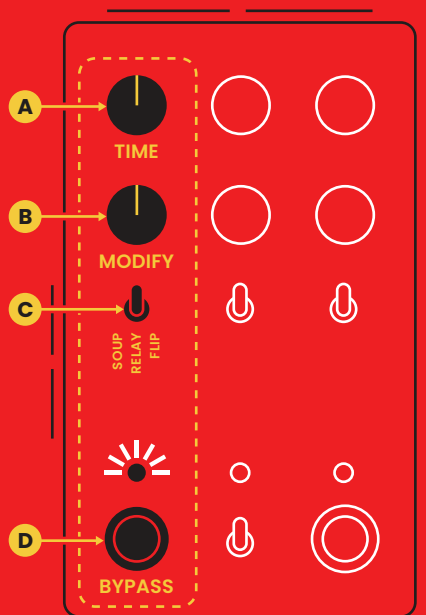
Controls what gets processed by the Wet Channel. This toggle only has an effect when both channels are on.

D

PRESETS

The left and right positions each store a preset, while the middle position is live (current settings). See pg. 18 for more on presets, including how to save.

Wet Channel Controls



Engage, adjust, select.

A

TIME

The function of this knob changes depending on the mode.

Soup - Decay / Size

Relay - Delay time

Flip - Lag / Spacing

B

MODIFY

The function of this knob changes depending on the mode.

Soup - Character

Relay - Feedback

Flip - Harmony

C

MODE

Selects between **Soup**, **Relay**, and **Flip** modes.

D

BYPASS

Activates the Wet Channel.

TAP



D

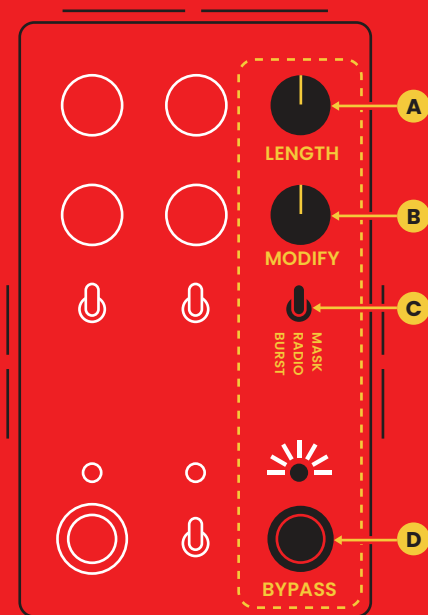
FREEZE

Freezes and infinitely repeats the current sound.

HOLD



Micro-Looper Channel Controls



Engage, adjust, select.

A

LENGTH

The function of this knob changes depending on the mode.

Burst - Size / Speed

Radio - Station dependent

Mask - Character

B

MODIFY

The function of this knob changes depending on the mode.

Burst - Sensitivity

Radio - Scan

Mask - Sensitivity

C

MODE

Selects between Burst, Radio, and Mask modes.

D

TAP

BYPASS

Alternates between recording and playback of a micro-loop.

 Recording  Playback

D

HOLD

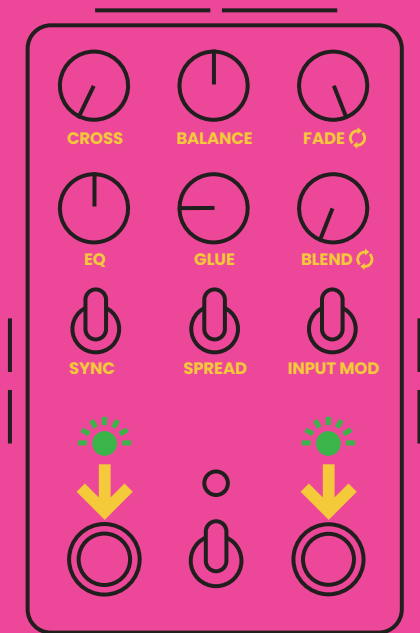


OVERDUBBING

Engages overdubbing, which records additional audio onto the micro-loop.

Hidden Options

Hold down both footswitches to access the Hidden Options. Both LEDs will light up green.



(Above settings are the default for all Hidden Options.)



CROSS

Introduces dynamic modulation of both amplitude and frequency, useful for musical and responsive variation. Assigned via INPUT MOD.



EQ

A two-way global EQ. Rotate the knob clockwise to remove low frequencies; rotate counter-clockwise to remove high frequencies. At noon the EQ will have no effect.



FADE

Turning this down will cause your loops to gradually fade while overdubbing, for slowly evolving loops or the ability to treat the Micro-Looper Channel like a delay.



BLEND

Allows you to blend in some of the clean micro-loop when it's routed through the Wet Channel.

Hidden Options Continued



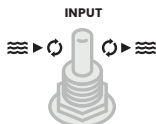
LEVEL BALANCE

Sets the relative loudness of the two channels.

MIX



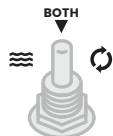
CLOCK



MODE

INPUT MOD

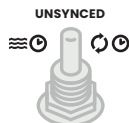
Selects the source for **CROSS** (pg. 43). You can modulate one channel with the other, or use your input to modulate both.



ROUTING

SPREAD

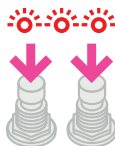
Lets you engage **SPREAD** (pg. 44) on one channel but not the other. This might be helpful if you want to keep your micro-loop mono, but have it pass through a stereo reverb.



MODE

SYNC

Allows you to sync one channel to the other. In the left position, the Micro-Looper is synced to the Wet Channel. The length of the micro-loop is now set by the **TIME** knob. In the right position, the Wet Channel is synced to the Micro-Looper. The **TIME** knob now moves in steps that are rhythmically related to the micro-loop length.



TRUE BYPASS

BAD MOOD uses buffered bypass. The bypassed signal is completely analog, but if you prefer true bypass we've built in a way to do that: Simply tap both footswitches three times. All three LEDs will blink red when you're in this state. Tap either footswitch to exit. (Note that the always-listening looper will not work until you exit true bypass).



To reset all the Hidden Options to their default setting, flip the preset toggle to the left position and back to center three times. Once you see the blinking lights, press both footswitches to confirm.

Presets

BAD MOOD lets you store and recall internal presets. All controls and knob positions – including the dip switches – are saved.

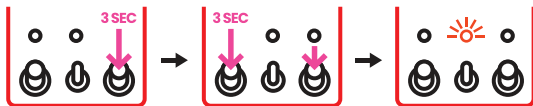
Presets are recalled using the toggle between the footswitches.



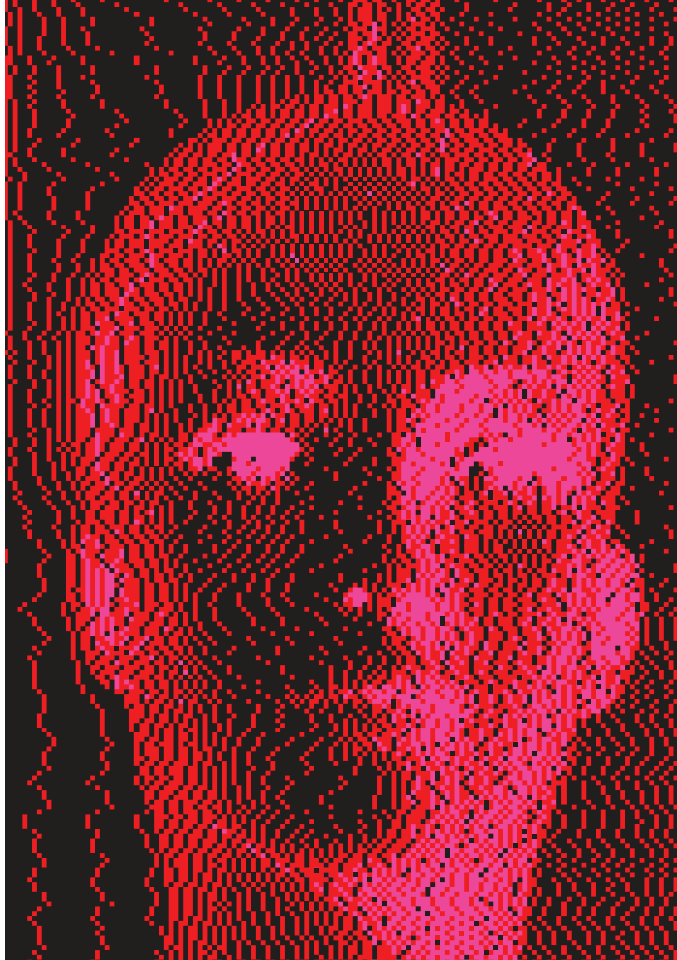
The left and right positions each contain a preset, and the middle position is a “live” state that matches the current controls of the pedal.

To save a preset to the right slot:

1. Hold down the right footswitch for three seconds
2. Then hold down the left footswitch for three seconds

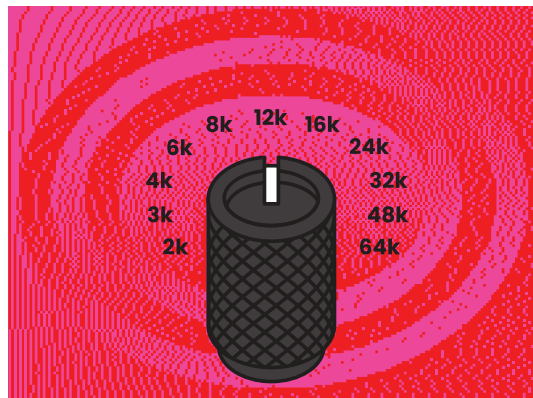


The middle LED will blink to indicate success. Do the same process in the opposite order for the left slot.



Clock

The **CLOCK** knob controls everything.



Specifically, it sets **BAD MOOD**'s sample rate.
The sample rate is responsible for:

WET CHANNEL

The quality and time of the effects.

MICRO-LOOPER CHANNEL

The length and resolution of the loops.

It's tone, length, and quality, all in one.

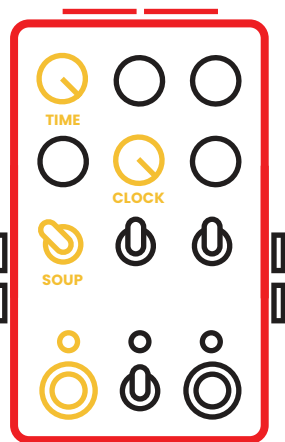
What makes it interesting is that it moves in musical, harmonized steps. For example, lowering the sample rate from 64k to 32k will halve the speed of your micro-loop as well as your Wet Channel effect.

TRY THIS:

Play a single note,
and while the
ambience decays,
turn down the **CLOCK**.



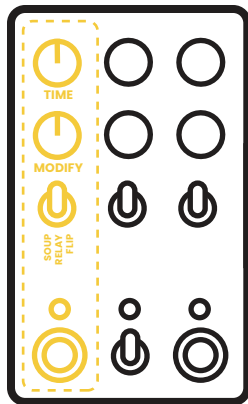
CLOCK



Now play another note and notice how much the character has changed.

***CLOCK** is your best bud as you explore all that **BAD MOOD** can do.*

Wet Channel



The Wet Channel is where you will find BAD MOOD's live effects.

It's a collection of unorthodox spatial treats that can process your micro-loops, input signal, or both.

Holding the bypass footswitch will freeze the current sound, causing it to repeat infinitely. How this will sound is different in each mode:

Soup - Ambient pad
Relay - Looping echo
Flip - Repeating chord

Each one has its own use, and will of course vary based on the knob settings. The next page has a few starter ideas.

Freeze Ideas

SYNTHETIC STARTER

 SOUP + 

Try freezing **Soup**, waiting for a few seconds, and then turning on the Micro-Looper. The reverb will be recorded into the micro-loop, giving you a nice starting sound to build on. Now unfreeze the reverb and play through it.

2-TRACK

 RELAY  MODIFY

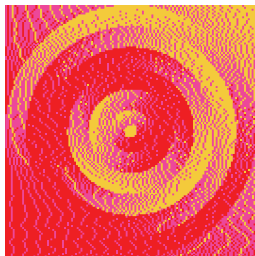
You can approach **Relay** like a second looper, making it possible to build layered compositions right inside of BAD MOOD. Just engage freeze when you want to preserve the current sound and not have your playing recorded. Try out different sync settings (pg. 17) to get the most out of this technique - you can go surprisingly far.

CHORD LOOPER

 FLIP  TIME

Turn up **TIME**, play a single note, and freeze **Flip**: You will now have a repeating pattern that you can transpose with **CLOCK** and re-harmonize with **MODIFY**. You can think of this one as a launching point for turning BAD MOOD into a strange little synth.

Soup Mode



Synthetic reverb.

Soup is a spectral reverb that resynthesizes your playing. It analyzes and recreates whatever passes through it, creating unnatural ambience that is a distant memory of your instrument. Use it to explore impossible spaces and synthetic dreamscapes, or to remake your instrument completely.

TIME

Sets the decay time.

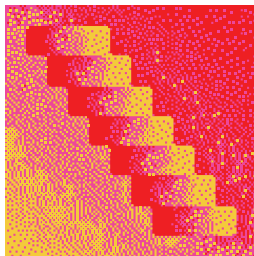
MODIFY

Sets the character. Rotate clockwise to emphasize **Soup's** synthetic nature.

CLOCK OUT

The sound and character of **Soup** is highly dependent on the **CLOCK** knob. In our opinion it sounds best when **CLOCK** is rolled back, but turning it up will introduce sparkling artifacts that might be your kind of thing.

Relay Mode



Abstract repeater.

Relay is a delay that doesn't fade out. Unlike a traditional delay where you control the amount of feedback, **Relay** lets you select a precise number of repeats that each share the same volume. You can think of it like a sampler that's always recording, and each sample can be repeated a chosen number of times.

TIME

Sets the delay time.

MODIFY

Sets the number of repeats. At max, repeats are stable and will pile up like a looper.

WHEN DID YOU GET HERE?

 MIX  MODIFY

Because "old echoes" and "new echoes" both have the same volume – without decaying feedback to distinguish the two – you can create unique, abstract sensations where old and new can't be told apart. It's a bit like an audio illusion, and can be a very fun spin on Frippertronics-style looping.

Flip Mode



Chordcaster.

Flip is a pitch shifter that creates layered harmonies to support your playing, but allows you to spread the different notes across time. It can be used for everything from pitch shifting to chord stacks to harmonic sequences.

TIME

Sets the lag time between notes.

MODIFY

Selects the harmony. You will find a variety of different arrangements of 4ths, 5ths, and octaves, going both up and down.

It works like this:

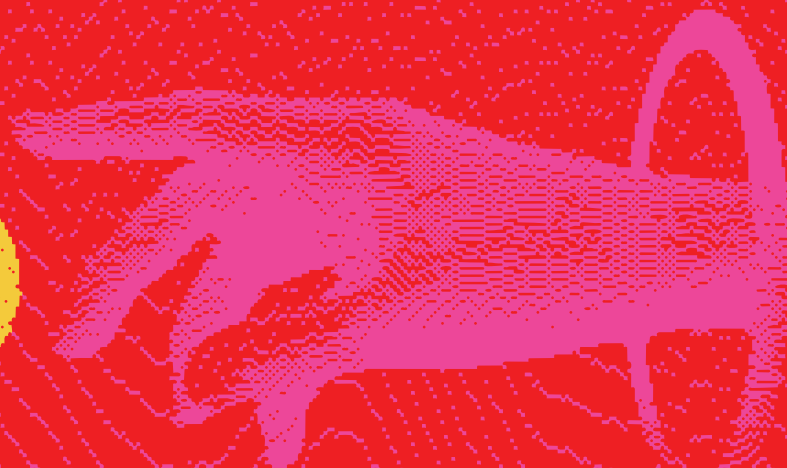
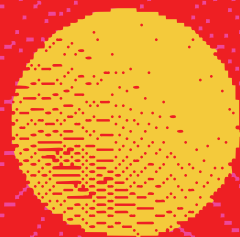


There are a wide variety of different harmonies mapped across the **MODIFY** knob. The higher the knob is set, the more notes will be present.

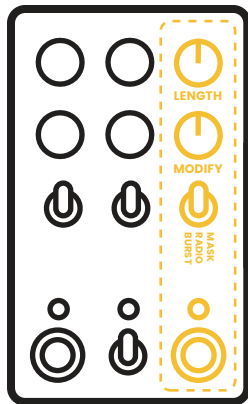


"VINTAGE" HARMONIES

Try turning up the **TIME** knob just a bit to replicate the laggy character of older pitch shifters and harmony effects.



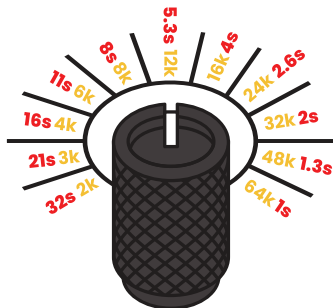
Micro-Looper Channel



The Micro-Looper on BAD MOOD is a bit unique.

It's an "always listening looper," which is like fishing for music: It is continuously recording when bypassed, and then you turn it on and see what you get. Instead of manually setting the length like a typical looper, it's set by the CLOCK position.

Here's how it breaks down:



To get started, simply play a few notes and turn the Micro-Looper on. It will keep whatever was played most recently and loop it. Now you can start modifying that sound or overdubbing on it.

It's important to note that the Micro-Looper has no stop command and is never really off.

It has three states:

 Recording  Playing  Overdubbing

The LED will blink while recording to show you the current loop length.

If the Wet Channel is on while the Micro-Looper is in its recording state, its effects will be recorded into your micro-loops.

TRAIL CATCHER - Try running a micro-loop through *Soup*, then briefly turning the Micro-Looper off and back on again. It will resample the *Soup* trails into the loop!

FREE PLAY - Once a micro-loop is recorded you can switch freely between the looping modes without it being erased.

Overdubbing

Once you've snagged a loop, you can start to pile sounds on top.

Simply hold the footswitch to start overdubbing.

There are a couple things to note:

WET OVERDUBS

While you *will* hear the Wet Channel's effects as you overdub, they will not be recorded into your micro-loops. This would create a loud, scary feedback loop. No thanks. Only your clean input signal will be overdubbed.



You *will* record the Wet Channel's effects when the Micro-Looper is in its bypassed, always-listening state (pg. 41).

MISPLACED OVERDUBS

Each of the Micro-Looper modes give you different ways to mess with the playback of your loop. If any of these effects are happening while overdubbing, the recorded audio may end up in a different place than you expect.

In practice this doesn't matter much because the loop will already be doing wild stuff, just toss some notes in there and see what happens. But for more traditional, predictable overdubbing, use these settings:



USE THE CLOCK! The **CLOCK** knob is an exception to the rule above. You can freely move the **CLOCK** knob while overdubbing and your notes will remain right where you played them. A great way to build harmonies that play at different speeds.

REPLACE

You can treat the bypass setting of the Micro-Looper Channel like a replace function. As soon as the channel is bypassed it starts to erase the existing loop and record the input audio in its place. This can be an interesting way to clear out some space or add glitches to your loops.

Burst Mode



Loop sequencer.

Burst mode takes your loops and turns them into rhythmic patterns of up to 8 steps. These patterns dynamically react to your instrument when in playback, to create randomizing “fills” when you play along.

LENGTH

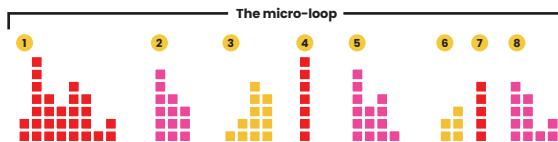
Sets the speed of the pattern / size of each step.

MODIFY

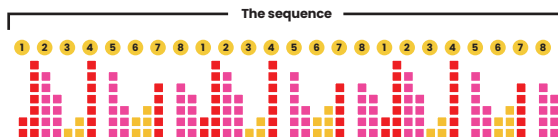
Sets the sensitivity of the envelope detector. When a sound is louder than the threshold while in playback, the pattern will be scrambled.

STABLE SEQUENCING

While Burst is chaotic by design, there are a couple ways to create more predictable patterns. The first is to simply record a micro-loop in one of the other modes first, and then switch over to Burst. The second is to play short, muted notes, so that the different sounds in the loop are neatly separated.



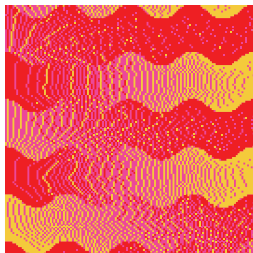
Burst mode turns a micro-loop into a sequence. Wherever a “unique” sound is detected in the loop, Burst creates a step. It then cycles through those slices of audio to create a pattern.



The strange part of Burst is that your overdubs are not directly recorded into the sequence, they are recorded into the micro-loop that it's built from. This means that what you hear and where you're being recorded are disconnected.

It's a playful and unpredictable process, but the steady pace of the sequencer ensures everything always feels rhythmically connected. See where it takes you.

Radio Mode



Shortwave looper.

Radio mode is its own little world. It contains five distinct loopers that take the same recording and interpret it into different genres spread across various stations. You can scan freely between the stations, introducing interference and combining the different loops.

LENGTH

Adjusts a different parameter for each station.

MODIFY

Scans through the stations.

DON'T TOUCH THAT DIAL

While it is very fun to scan around Radio's different stations and scramble them together, it's worth slowing down and getting to know them in isolation as well. Each station is essentially a mode of its own, and there's a spot across **MODIFY's** sweep that contains a clean, pure version of each one. Simply scan the **MODIFY** knob until you reach an area where the static parts, and you will know you've arrived at a station.



TAPE

LENGTH - Speed / Direction

Plays your loop back in full with no funny business, but lets you change its playback speed and/or direction.

AMBIENT

LENGTH - Playback speed

Maintains the pitch of your loop but lets you slow it down dramatically, turning it into a cinematic blur.

ORCHESTRAL

LENGTH - # of voices

A symphony of different voices that come in and out, creating a unique arrangement of your loop.

SHOEGAZE

LENGTH - Moment selector

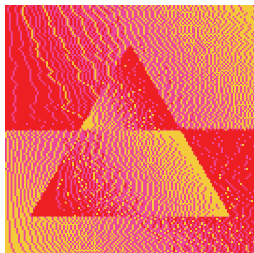
Converts your micro-loop into a collection of frozen moments that last forever. You can then navigate through different stacked layers of those moments.

DANCE

LENGTH - Rotation speed

Rotates steadily between three different versions of your loop: Half speed, double speed, and normal speed. Club night at the circus.

Mask Mode



Loop disguiser.

Mask is a noise-sensitive mode that takes the loud parts of your loop and turns them into something new. Any sound over the volume threshold is changed in a way of your choosing, giving you a musical push and pull as the mask turns on and off.

LENGTH

Sets the character of the mask.

MODIFY

Sets the threshold for the mask. The higher this is turned up, the more of your loop will be disguised.

THRESHOLD SURFING

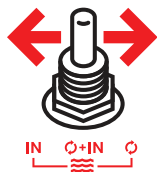
Mask mode can be used for many things depending on where **MODIFY** is set. One of our favorite uses is to find the spot where only the transients of your notes are masked, creating mysterious, ear-catching bursts. On the other extreme, you can max out **MODIFY** to apply the mask at all times. Each loop you record will bring out a different response.



A GOOD LISTEN

Because there's often a lot going on in the other loop modes, **Mask** is a useful place for getting a quick listen to the micro-loop without any funny business. Just turn **MODIFY** all the way down and you will be hearing the pure micro-loop recording. This is also a good position for building up a micro-loop if you want more precision, before bringing it into the other modes.

Routing



The middle toggle controls **BAD MOOD's** routing.

It decides what gets processed by the Wet Channel, and it only applies when both channels are currently active.



INPUT ONLY

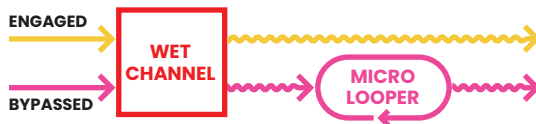


INPUT + MICRO-LOOPER CHANNEL



MICRO-LOOPER CHANNEL ONLY

The routing control makes it possible, for example, to dunk your micro-loops into the **Soup**, but leave your instrument clean as you play over top.



There's one important aspect of **BAD MOOD's** routing to be aware of: When the Micro-Looper Channel is in its always-listening state (bypassed), it will record the sounds from the Wet Channel regardless of the routing setting. If you're playing through **Relay** mode before engaging the Micro-Looper, for example, the loop will have those repeats captured within it.

WET LOOPS

By default, any micro-loops routed through the Wet Channel will become 100% wet. In other words, the "dry" version of the micro-loop will be replaced by the processed version. But you can blend some of the clean micro-loop back in using the Hidden Options (pg. 15).

Glue

BAD MOOD includes a hidden global effect that's tucked behind the **CLOCK knob**. It's a blend of different ingredients that let you choose **BAD MOOD**'s base character.

GLUE comes right at the end of the pedal's signal chain, and applies to both channels.



Set it low to warm up and gel the two channels, set it high to completely thrash everything passing through the pedal, or explore a variety of flavors in-between.

By default it's set pretty low, but you should turn it up if you really want to be bad.

You can use **GLUE** on the dry signal as well, just turn on the **DRY GLUE** dip switch (pg. 45). Try rolling back **MIX** completely with this on, this will isolate **GLUE** and turn **BAD MOOD** into a stereo saturator / destroyer.

Cross

BAD MOOD contains a unique form of modulation that dynamically interferes with both pitch and loudness. It can modulate itself or be modulated by your playing.

The intensity of this modulation is set by **CROSS**.

The source of this modulation is set by **INPUT MOD**.



The simplest way to hear what it does is to use your input as the source, turn **CROSS** way up, and play through the **Soup** mode. Notice how it bends and sputters as you play. But where it really becomes interesting is when you use one channel to modulate the other, creating a living sense of interconnectedness within the pedal.

CROSS is off by default to avoid confusion, but don't overlook it!

Customize



The yellow-labeled dip switches on top of BAD MOOD allow you to engage alternate behaviors and set things to your liking.

MISO

Mono In, Stereo Out. Splits a mono input signal into a stereo output signal.

SPREAD

Turns on stereo processing. Each mode has its own unique approach to generating a stereo image.

DRY KILL

Removes your clean signal from the output of the pedal (even when bypassed).

TRAILS

Allows the effects to naturally fade out after the pedal is bypassed.

LATCH

Changes the hold function for each footswitch from momentary to latching, so that it will remain engaged until the footswitch is held again.

HALF

Cuts the loop length in half, matching the response of the original MOOD (loop length is relative to the CLOCK setting, see pg. 30).

SMOOTH

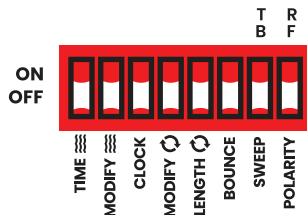
Removes the harmonized stepping effect from the CLOCK knob for fluid adjustment.

DRY GLUE

Applies the effects of GLUE (pg. 42) to your dry signal. Use this to help mesh the wet and dry signals together, or to treat GLUE as a standalone effect by turning MIX all the way down.

The dip switch settings are saved with your presets.

Ramping



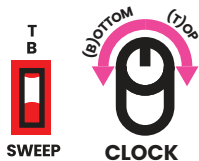
Ramping gives you the ability to automate BAD MOOD's knobs, either as a one-time movement (ramp) or continuous motion (bounce).

It's easier to get started with bounce, so let's do that. We're essentially going to modulate a knob.



1. Engage **BOUNCE**.

2. Choose which knob(s) you wish to control.



3. Choose the sweep.



4. Set the speed.



Now BAD MOOD will steadily move between different **CLOCK** settings. The position of the knob you're controlling is important, because it sets either the maximum or minimum point of the range (depending on the **SWEEP** setting).

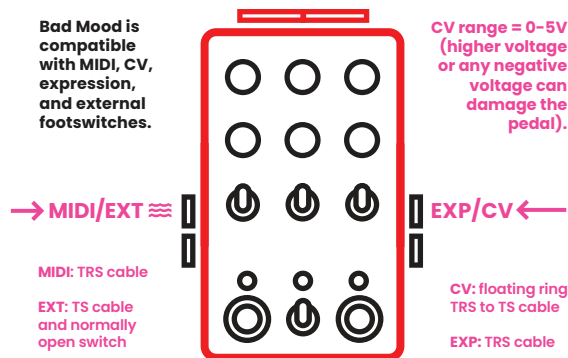
Ramp is the same idea, but the movement only happens once when you turn the pedal on. Your chosen knob(s) either rise or fall to the position set by the knob, then stay there. Useful for creating a wave of motion and activity when you first turn BAD MOOD on.

Check out the Dip Switches 101 guide on our website for a step-by-step on ramping.

Ramping is engaged as soon as the dip switch for a corresponding knob is set to ON. At this point, the **MIX** knob automatically changes to control the ramp speed. You can still adjust **MIX** while ramping by holding down the left footswitch as you move the knob.

External Control

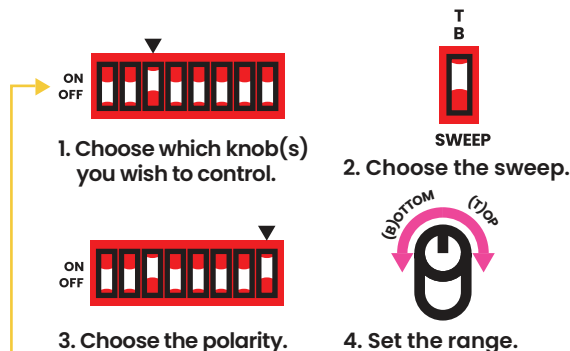
Bad Mood is compatible with MIDI, CV, expression, and external footswitches.



CV and expression can be used to control BAD MOOD's knobs.

MIDI lets you go deeper and control everything, including clock sync, the Hidden Options, and the dip switches.

CV and expression are set up the same way as ramping using the dip switches on the top of the pedal. The pedal will simply detect a CV or expression signal when you plug it in and hand over control.



If you plug in a CV or expression signal but engage none of the knobs, you will have control over MIX.

MIDI requires a Chase Bliss MIDIbox to convert the signal to a 1/4" TRS jack. For details on getting MIDI going with BAD MOOD, check out the MIDI manual.

The MIDI jack can also be used to engage BAD MOOD's Wet Channel with an external footswitch. Useful for tabletop setups. Plug in any normally-open momentary footswitch with a TS cable and you're all set; it takes control automatically.

BYE

This is the end of the
BAD MOOD manual.

Hope you're feeling bad!

Write us anytime if you'd
like to know more:
help@chasebliss.com

We're happy to help.

Enjoy!

